

TERROR IN THE NIGHT

■ Fall River mourns the deaths of nine residents in fire at an assisted living facility.

■ Elder advocates raise concerns about oversight of such facilities by the state and cities.

■ Witnesses and survivors describe horror, chaos, and confusion as smoke spread.

“They both tell me every-day they love me, and I tell them I love them. My soul has been ripped out.”

— Lorraine Ferrara, 71, said two of her “dear friends” died in the fire

“All these lights are flashing inside, and people are banging [on the windows] wanting to get out. They’re yelling and I couldn’t help. I kept going ‘Wait a minute, wait a minute.’ I feel terrible.”

— Shirley Cambra, 75

“I could only get it open that much, and I’m screaming at the firemen to help me out and other people. I finally got fed up with that and I stood up and I grabbed the top of that window and I ripped it right off the hinges.”

— Michael Pimentel, 72

A resident of the Gabriel House in Fall River was led to a nearby parking lot late Sunday.



MARK STOCKWELL FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Tragedy lays bare questions of oversight

By Marin Wolf and Jason Laughlin

GLOBE STAFF

and Ava Berger

GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

The Gabriel House assisted living facility did not perform fire drills or train workers in evacuation procedures and was understaffed and poorly maintained, according to a current and former employee interviewed in the aftermath of the fatal fire there that killed nine residents.

“These people did not deserve what they got,” said Debbie Johnson, a certified nursing assistant who has worked at the Fall River facility for four years. “They did not deserve those living quarters that they lived in.”

The tragedy has renewed questions about the way the state regulates such facilities. Advocates **GABRIEL REGULATION, Page A7**

HEAVY FIRE WAS COMING

from the front door of the facility when firefighters responded around 9:30 p.m. Sunday, officials said.



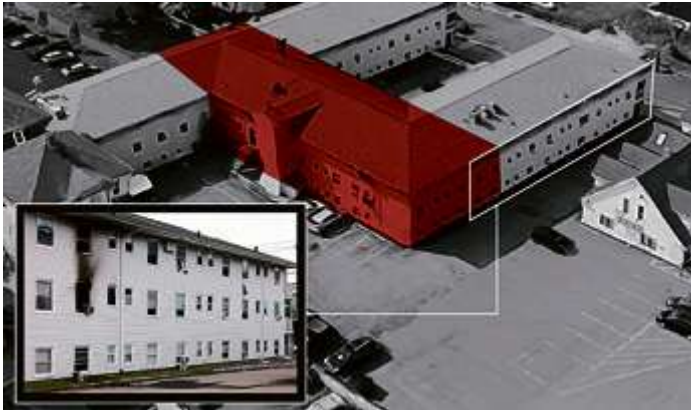
THE FIRE WAS CONTAINED

to one part of the building, but smoke traveled throughout the facility.



RESIDENTS BROKE WINDOWS

to escape the smoke and firefighters plucked some people from windows.



SOURCE: Globe reporting, Fall River Fire Department. CREDIT: Ryan Huddle/Globe Staff; Photograph by Mark Stockwell for The Boston Globe; Gabriel House building Google Earth

Blaze leaves trail of anguish, loss, and distressing concerns

This story was reported by Ava Berger, Christopher Gavin, Omar Mohammed, John R. Ellement, John Hilliard, Amanda Kaufman, Collin Robisheaux, Adam Sennott, and Emily Sweeney. It was written by Danny McDonald.

FALL RIVER — Some screamed for help as the flames and smoke got closer. Others smashed windows, desperate for a rescue. Firefighters exhausted themselves dragging and carrying mostly elderly residents to safety.

One resident considered jumping to safety. “I was just hoping I was going to make it,” said Neal Beck, 78, who was rescued through a third-floor window.

When Frank O’Reagan, a Fall River fire captain, arrived on the scene at the Gabriel House assisted living facility Sunday night, he was told people were still trapped on the third floor. He went in without an air tank, and kicked in a door.

In some rooms he entered, he only found bodies.

The blaze that tore through a part of the facility here Sunday night sent black smoke billowing through apartment units filled with residents, many with health complications or mobility issues, in what became the deadliest Massachusetts fire in more than 40 years. Nine people died, and more than 30 were injured.

The cause is still under investigation, but officials said Monday that the fire was not suspicious.

Questions have been raised about conditions in the facility, the city’s and state’s oversight of it, and about the Fire Department’s capacity to adequately respond to a fire in a complex where roughly 70 residents were living.

“I don’t think we’ve ever faced something like this,” said a visibly shaken Mayor Paul Coogan, as he stood outside the Gabriel House Assisted Living Facility Monday morning.

Fall River Fire Chief Jeffrey Bacon said the deaths felt like “a failure of our job,” despite his department doing all it could.

The deceased residents have been identified as: 64-year-old Rui Albernaz; 61-year-old Ronald Codega; 69-year-old Marga

FIRE, Page A6

Survivors recount harrowing escapes

By Christopher Gavin and Claire Thornton

GLOBE STAFF

and Ava Berger and Maria Probert

GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

FALL RIVER — She doesn’t remember the firefighter carrying her down a ladder from her second-floor unit at Gabriel House.

She does remember looking back across Oliver Street as chaos unfolded when heavy fire tore through the assisted living center.

Residents squeezing through windows. Firefighters smashing windows to free those trapped inside the three-story building.

“It was just a nightmare,” Lorraine Ferrara, 71, said Monday, wiping tears from her reddened eyes. “All the ambulances and fire trucks, people

WITNESSES, Page A6

Midsummer classic

Tuesday: Hazy and humid. High 83-88, low 70-75.

Wednesday: Sunny and hot. High 86-91, low 68-73.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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The Supreme Court allowed the Trump administration to fire more than a thousand Education Department employees, functionally dismantling the agency. **A10.**

Unneighborly Nantucket: An owner of a \$9 million home reportedly cut down his neighbor’s trees, leading to a more sweeping ocean view and a lawsuit. **B1.**

Most Bostonians are not receiving the cheapest power option that the city offers. **B1.**

Trump threatens Russia with tariffs over airstrikes

Frustrated by lack of truce progress, he restores weapons pipeline to Kyiv

By Erica L. Green

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — President Trump said Monday he would help Europe speed more weapons to Ukraine and warned Russia that if it did not agree to a peace deal within 50 days, he would impose a new round of punishing sanctions.

The announcement comes as

Trump carries out a remarkable shift in tone — if not in practice — on the war in Ukraine from his first months in office, when he looked to leverage his personal relationship with President Vladimir Putin of Russia to end the war.

“He’s fooled a lot of people,” Trump said of Putin, who launched an unprovoked full in-

vasion on Ukraine in 2022 and escalated attacks amid peace negotiations this year, even as Trump tried to end the fighting.

“He fooled Clinton, Bush, Obama, Biden — he didn’t fool me,” Trump said, seemingly sensitive to the perception that he was changing his tune on the Russian president.

Speaking from the Oval Office, where he met with NATO Secretary General Mark Rutte, Trump said that a range of artillery would be “quickly distribut-

ed to the battlefield,” in a deal brokered by Rutte and European leaders. Under the deal, the United States would sell Patriot air defense missiles to NATO members, which would then supply them to Ukraine.

“We’ll send them a lot of weapons of all kinds,” Trump said. “And they’re going to deliver those weapons immediately to the site, to the site of the war, different sites of the war, and they’re going to pay for 100 per-

UKRAINE, Page A4